SOUTHLAND INDUSTRIES · NORTHERN CALIFORNIA SERVICE

Internal Sites: Security Debrief and Hosting Plan

The Dispatch Hub, Start-Up SOPs, and Employee Lifecycle sites run on GitHub's free plan at $0, inside a Southland-owned GitHub organization. They are hardened to the standard a static internal site can reach. Their one real limit is that they are public, so sensitive material stays on SharePoint.

Prepared by Crystal Jeffers 3 sites · 14 editors

Decision needed

SUMMARY

Making the sites viewable only by Southland staff is possible in three ways. The cheapest costs $0, a Microsoft-only option costs about $324 a year, and GitHub Enterprise costs about $3,500 a year for 14 editors. Each depends on IT. Corporate's decision is which path to fund once the team outgrows public pages.

What was done and why MEASURES

MEASURE	WHY IT MATTERS
Southland-owned GitHub organization	The company owns the sites, every account must use two-step sign-in, and admin actions are logged
Editor email addresses kept private	Saves never show an editor's personal email
Safety filter on all page text	A stolen editor account can't add a script that runs for every reader
Content Security Policy	The browser refuses scripts, fonts, and images from anywhere not approved
Page code served from the site	An outage or tampered file at a public CDN can't break or hijack the site
Check-before-publish gate	Broken code, missing pages or images, and contact details are blocked before going live. The live site stays on the last good version.
Protected history	No one can erase or rewrite the record of changes
Secret scanning and dependency alerts	Passwords or keys are caught before they're saved, and outdated code triggers an alert
Typo banner and 404 page	A mistake shows the file and line, or a branded page, instead of a blank site
Anonymized screenshots	Screenshots show realistic sample customers and account numbers, never real data
Hidden from search engines	The sites don't show up in Google
Compressed images	18.8 MB to 6.4 MB, so pages load quickly on phones
Monthly backup to SharePoint	A full copy exists outside GitHub
Editor guide	Covers account setup, failed checks, undoing a change, and what to do if something goes wrong

Together, these keep a broken or unsafe change from ever reaching readers.

IT security review CHECKLIST

The checklist an IT security team would work through for an internal tool, and where each item stands.

AREA	WHAT IT WOULD CONFIRM	STATUS
Identity	Each editor uses their own account, and shared logins are banned	In place
Identity	Two-step sign-in is required for every account	In place
Identity	Editors sign in with their Southland login (SSO)	Needs GitHub Enterprise
Access	The organization is owned by Southland, with at least two owners	In place
Access	Editors get edit rights only, never admin	In place
Access	Departing editors are removed the same day, and access is reviewed every quarter	In place
Change control	Every change records who, when, and exactly what changed	In place
Change control	Broken or risky changes are blocked before they go live	In place
Change control	Any change can be undone, with a plain-language guide	In place
Change control	History can't be erased or rewritten	In place
Change control	A basic log of admin actions (invites, setting changes)	In place
Change control	A full audit log with export and streaming	Needs GitHub Enterprise
Data	Content is sorted into public, internal, and confidential, and confidential stays on SharePoint	In place
Data	No customer data, account numbers, or contact details on any page	In place
Data	Leaked passwords or keys are caught before they're saved	In place

Web security	Page text is sanitized, scripts are limited by policy, and HTTPS is enforced	`In place`
Web security	Outside code is pinned, and known vulnerabilities trigger alerts	`In place`
Web security	Protection from being framed by another site (clickjacking)	`Needs private hosting`
Errors	A broken change can't take the site down	`In place`
Errors	Failed saves tell the editor exactly what to fix	`In place`
Availability	A backup exists outside GitHub	`In place`
Availability	99.9% uptime guarantee	`Needs GitHub Enterprise`
Response	A written plan for a bad change or a stolen account: who to call, how to take a site offline, and how to revert	`In place`

The service manager owns the organization and manages editor access.

Types of risk considered FRAMEWORK

A checklist confirms controls exist. These categories explain why each control is there, and they guide decisions about risks no checklist covers yet.

CATEGORY	THE QUESTION IT ASKS	HOW THE SITES ANSWER IT
Confidentiality	Who can see this, and who should?	Classification rule, anonymized screenshots, confidential content on SharePoint
Integrity	Can content be changed without anyone knowing, or changed wrongly?	Own accounts, protected history, the publish check, sanitized page text
Availability	Will it be there when a technician needs it?	Publish gate keeps the last good version, error banner, offsite backup
Identity and access	Is the person signed in who they claim, and do they still need access?	Two-step sign-in, edit-only rights, same-day removal, quarterly review
Third-party and supply chain	What if a service or library we depend on fails or is compromised?	Pinned, integrity-checked code served from the site, dependency alerts
People and process	What happens when someone makes an honest mistake?	Plain-language error messages, undo guide, checks that catch typos
Continuity	Does the system survive if its builder or owner leaves?	Company-owned organization, two owners, written guides
Compliance and privacy	Does anything here create a legal or privacy obligation?	No customer or personal data on pages, private editor emails
Scale	Which of these get harder as editors and content grow?	The hosting plan below, with capacity math and a funding trigger

> The guiding principle is defense in depth: no single control is trusted alone. If one fails, such as an editor mistake getting past the guide, another catches it, such as the publish check.

Risk bar CLASSIFICATION

The test: if this page landed in a competitor's or stranger's inbox, would it matter? If yes, it goes on SharePoint and the site links to it.

LEVEL	EXAMPLES	WHERE IT LIVES
Public	Process steps, how-tos, checklists, sample screenshots with fake data, the main support line	Public site
Internal	Coworker first names and roles, team structure, tool names	Public site for now. Moves to private hosting when funded.
Confidential	Customer names and sites, account, PO, and cost code numbers, pricing, contracts, vendor terms, personal phones and emails, anything under NDA	SharePoint only, linked from the site
Never	Passwords, API keys, shared logins, employee personal data	Not stored on any site

The publish check enforces part of this automatically by blocking emails and phone numbers. The rest relies on editors following the guide, which is the main reason private hosting matters as the team grows.

Editors and the audit trail PEOPLE

8 editors today and 14 once 6 more field supervisors join: the dispatcher, the dispatch supervisor, the service manager, the field supervisors, and Crystal. Everyone edits.

- **Own accounts.** Each save is signed with the editor's name, so the history shows who did what.
- **Built-in audit trail.** Every save records who, when, and the exact lines changed. The History button on any page shows this, and any version can be restored.
- **Two people editing at once.** GitHub warns the second person when the page changed while they were working.
- **Mistakes.** The publish check blocks broken saves, and anything else can be undone from History in about a minute.
- **What free can't do.** Tie editor accounts to Southland logins, or require approval on private repos.

Capacity PUBLISH MINUTES

Each save runs two short jobs in 30 to 40 seconds. GitHub rounds each job up to a full minute, so one save uses about 2 minutes. Minutes are unlimited while the repos are public.

PLAN	MINUTES / MONTH	SAVES / MONTH	PER EDITOR / WEEK (14)
Free, public (today)	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited
Free organization, private	2,000	≈1,000	≈16
Team · $4 per user per month	3,000	≈1,500	≈25
Enterprise Cloud · $21 per user per month	50,000	≈25,000	400+

A busy week of 5 saves per editor is about 300 saves a month, which fits every plan. A monthly spending cap of $0 rules out a surprise bill.

Private hosting options

COST · 14 USERS

OPTION	YEARLY COST	VIEWERS SIGN IN WITH	MAIN TRADE-OFF
Cloudflare Access + Pages	$0 up to 50 users	Southland Microsoft login	A new vendor for IT to review. $7 per user per month past 50.
Azure Static Web Apps	≈$324	Southland Microsoft login	Needs an Azure subscription from IT. Stays inside Microsoft.
GitHub Enterprise Cloud	≈$3,528 + $252 per reader	GitHub account linked to Southland login	Every reader is a paid seat, so cost grows with headcount
SharePoint pages only	$0	Southland Microsoft login	Loses the checks, design, and editing workflow. Full rebuild.

If IT has GitHub Enterprise

Connect Southland's organization to the enterprise and switch on private Pages. Cost is only unlicensed seats. Strongest audit log and a 99.9% uptime guarantee.

If IT has no GitHub

Azure Static Web Apps if IT prefers Microsoft, or Cloudflare at $0 if IT approves the vendor. Same sign-in result for a fraction of Enterprise.

Recommendation

NEXT STEPS

Keep the free public sites, with confidential content on SharePoint, until the team passes about 15 editors or a page needs internal-only content. Then fund the path that matches IT's answer.

- Ask IT whether Southland has GitHub Enterprise, and whether they would approve Cloudflare or an Azure Static Web App.
- Confirm GitHub Enterprise seat rules for read-only viewers with GitHub sales before quoting.

Sources PRICING

- GitHub: changing the visibility of a Pages site
- GitHub: Actions minutes by plan
- GitHub: plans and pricing
- Cloudflare Access plans
- Azure Static Web Apps plans

List prices in USD. Confirm with each vendor before purchase.